



RUSTIC HEART

Homemade food. Proven recipes. *A business in a box.*

Rustic Heart pairs a working farmstand with a licensing arm that sells home cooks the recipes, playbook, and web presence to skip years of trial and error.

Debbie Crick • Founder • Cornville, Arizona

Preliminary pitch deck • July 2026 • Confidential





THE STORY

Meet Debbie Crick

Debbie built The Rustic Heart Farmstand on Cornville Road, Arizona — a roadside stand selling pies, cakes, cookies, jams, preserves, farm eggs, and jar mixes, all made from scratch. Open Thursday through Saturday, it has become a proven local business with sell-out products and a recognizable brand.

Along the way she solved every problem a home food business faces: which recipes sell, how to price them, how to comply with cottage-food rules, how to present a stand, and how to keep customers coming back.



“That hard-won know-how is the product. Rustic Heart sells the food — and licenses everything I learned making it.”

THE PROBLEM

Great home cooks fail as businesses — not as cooks



Years of trial and error

New producers burn seasons testing recipes, prices, packaging, and venues before anything reliably sells.



No playbook exists

Cottage-food rules, labeling, costing, and display know-how are scattered — most learn by expensive mistakes.



Invisible online

Most home food businesses never get a real web presence, so discovery stops at the end of their street.

THE TYPICAL COTTAGE-FOOD BUSINESS

\$2,000

median annual sales

\$500

median annual profit

15 hrs/week

typical time invested for that return

Institute for Justice survey of 775 cottage-food producers

THE OPPORTUNITY

The market is opening up fast



34 states

have created or expanded homemade-food laws since 2015
— a nationwide deregulation wave.



No sales cap

in Arizona: free registration, no permit fees, no kitchen
inspection, and expanded wholesale under HB 2509.



1,400+

new cottage-food businesses formed in Texas in the first
year after legalization; 1,200+ in California.



49%

of new U.S. business owners in 2023 were women (up from
29% in 2019) — the core cottage-food demographic.

THE MODEL

One brand, two engines



THE FARMSTAND

Sell the food

- Retail sales Thu–Sat on Cornville Road
- Proven, differentiated products
- Test kitchen for every new recipe
- Cash flow and brand proof today



THE LICENSE

Sell the know-how

- License proven recipes to home cooks
- Business guidance that skips years of trial and error
- Optional web domain + ready-built website
- High-margin, scalable revenue

The flywheel: the farmstand proves what sells — every license ships recipes the stand has already perfected in front of paying customers.

THE PRODUCT

A license that skips the years of trial and error



STARTER

Recipe Library

- Battle-tested recipe collection
- Ingredient costing + sourcing notes
- Scaling and shelf-life guidance



SIGNATURE

Recipes + Playbook

- Everything in Starter
- Pricing, packaging, and labeling guides
- Cottage-food compliance walkthrough
- Stand setup, sampling, and mentoring



TURNKEY

Business in a Box

- Everything in Signature
- Your own web domain
- Ready-built brand website
- Social + menu templates

Head start: two complete Rustic Heart website concepts are already designed — the web package ships from day one.

BUSINESS MODEL

Five ways Rustic Heart earns



Farmstand retail

Pies, cakes, preserves, eggs, coffee, jar mixes sold Thu–Sat

Recurring · today



License fees

One-time fee per home cook joining a tier (Starter / Signature / Turnkey)

One-time · high margin



Annual renewals

Yearly renewal for updated recipes, seasonal menus, and continued support

Recurring · compounding



Web packages

Domain + site build, plus modest annual hosting and upkeep

One-time + recurring



Wholesale & kits (future)

Jar-mix kits and branded goods supplied to licensees and local retailers

Future upside

ILLUSTRATIVE ECONOMICS

What the two engines could look like

Placeholder assumptions for discussion only — to be replaced with actual farmstand figures and validated license pricing.

ASSUMPTIONS (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Starter / Signature / Turnkey pricing

\$1,500 / \$4,500 / \$7,500

Annual renewal

\$500 per licensee

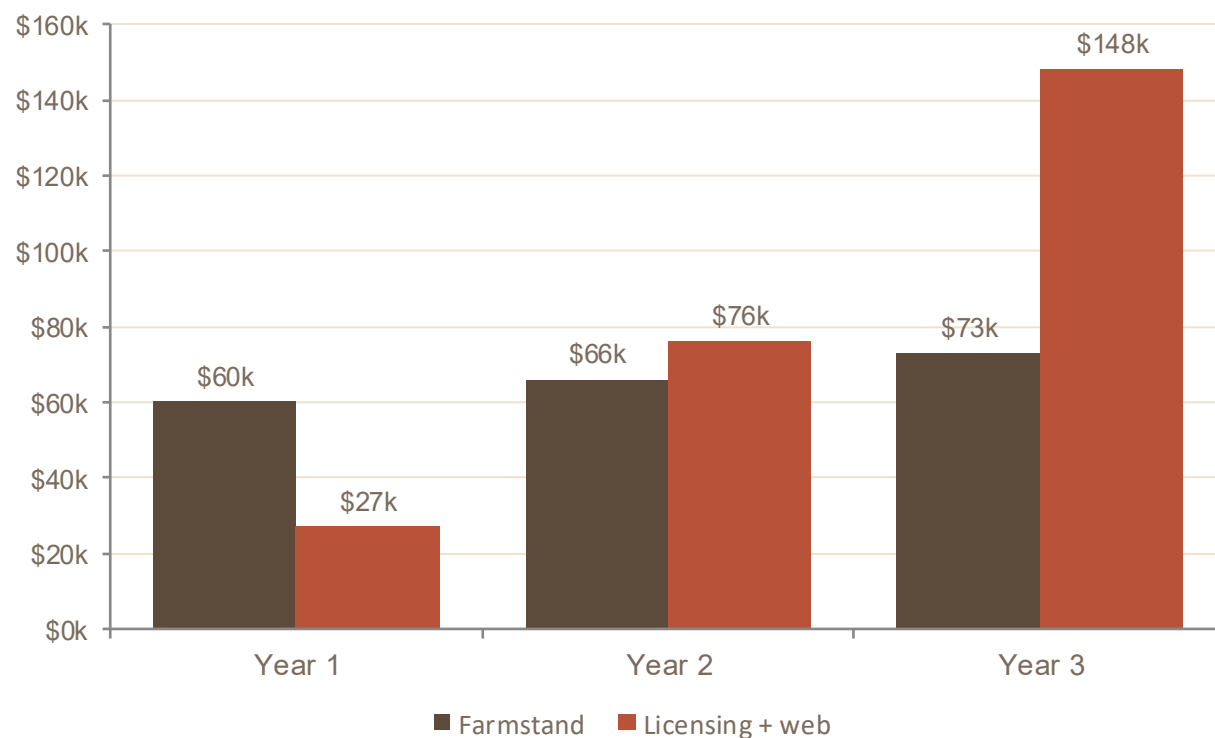
Licensees signed

Yr 1: 6 • Yr 2: 15 • Yr 3: 28

Farmstand gross (est.)

\$60k, growing ~10%/yr

Illustrative revenue by engine (\$k)





TRACTION

The flagship already works



Operating now

Open Thursday–Saturday on Cornville Road, with regulars and roadside traffic



Sell-out demand

Farm eggs routinely sell out; samples convert passers-by into customers



Differentiated goods

Gluten-free carrot cake, Lemon Buttermilk pie, \$22 local-roast coffee, soup & salad jar mixes



Brand already built

Logo, voice, and two complete website concepts designed and ready to deploy

PRECEDENTS

Home kitchens have scaled before



Nothing Bundt Cakes

Started in a Las Vegas home kitchen (1997)

Grew into 500+ bakeries across North America on the strength of a tight, proven product line.



Auntie Anne's

Began at a Pennsylvania farmers-market stand (1988)

One perfected pretzel recipe became a global franchise with thousands of locations.



Mrs. Fields

One home chocolate-chip cookie recipe (1977)

Later pivoted to a licensing-driven model — proof that the recipe and brand, not the storefronts, carry the value.

The Rustic Heart twist: instead of \$250k+ franchises, license the recipes and playbook at a price a home cook can actually afford — and grow with a thousand small kitchens.

ROADMAP

From one stand to a thousand kitchens

1

Formalize the IP

NOW – 6 MONTHS

- Document recipes, costing, and the playbook
- Trademark Rustic Heart brand
- Draft license agreements with counsel
- Keep flagship revenue growing

2

Pilot licensees

6 – 18 MONTHS

- Sign 3–5 pilot home cooks in Arizona
- Launch the Turnkey web package
- Refine support + renewal model
- Capture testimonials and results

3

Expand the table

18 MONTHS +

- Roll out across food-freedom states
- Licensee community and seasonal menus
- Wholesale jar-mix and kit line
- Explore regional farmstand partners

Risks and how the structure answers them



License vs. franchise line

A trademark license + significant assistance + a fee can legally be a franchise under the FTC Franchise Rule, triggering FDD disclosure. Structure the license deliberately with counsel — or comply as a low-cost franchise.



Recipes are weak IP alone

Recipes per se are not copyrightable. Value is protected by bundling: trade-secret playbook, trademarked brand, ongoing support, and renewals.



Cottage-food rules vary by state

Arizona is highly favorable; other states cap revenue or venues. Licensee eligibility must be screened state-by-state as the map expands.



Food safety & liability

Licensees are independent businesses — agreements must require training and insurance, and disclaim any agency relationship with Rustic Heart.



RUSTIC HEART

Let's set a bigger table.



Validate pricing

Interview 10 prospective home-cook licensees on tier pricing and demand



Engage counsel

Franchise/licensing attorney to structure the license the right way



Package the IP

Finish documenting recipes, costing, and the operating playbook



Replace placeholders

Load actual farmstand financials into this deck

[The ask — funding amount or partnership terms — to be added once financials are final]